

Digital Marathon

Your digital workday, measured. A guide to version 2.1.31.



Measure mouse travel, keys, clicks and active time. Review trends, export totals or create a named certificate. Version **2.1.31** adds public metadata fallback when GitHub API checks fail or are rate-limited. Mini View stays compact; Full View has one review panel. One ZIP contains Mac and Windows. Local development needs no Apple Developer account or notarization. Analytics is automatic; history stays local. Download while working, then restart when ready. The approved **Pearl & Aqua** icon, certificate and transparency controls stay the same.

At a glance	What you get
Live activity	Mouse distance, key presses, clicks and active time, with history from hours to five years.
Daily use	Classic Mac Full View, familiar compact Mini View and shared 0-75% transparency bars.
Direct launch	One ZIP and folder: the complete Mac .app, Windows .bat and bundled runtimes.
Certificate	Selected-range report, named JPEG download and the original gold laptop award badge.
Updates	Startup and 15-minute checks, with public metadata fallback; verified download, then install when ready.
Privacy	Activity totals stay local; basic app/feature analytics starts automatically.

Supported computers

The direct launch package supports Apple Silicon Macs with macOS 11 or later and Windows 10/11 x64. Linux retains its original launcher and first-launch build. An Intel Mac app and native Windows ARM runtime are not included.

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Start with one shared folder

Extract once, then open the launcher for your computer.

Computer	File to double-click
Apple Silicon Mac	Digital Marathon.app
Windows x64	Start Digital Marathon - Windows.bat
Linux	Start Screen Recorder - Linux.sh (existing first-launch build)

- Use **digital-marathon-cross-platform-v2.1.31-click-to-launch.zip**, locally or from GitHub Releases. Source code archives lack the runtime/JAR for direct launch.
- Extract the ZIP completely before launching. Open the resulting **digital-marathon** folder.
- Mac and Windows include Java; no terminal, Java installation, first-launch build or download is needed.
- On Windows, keep the .bat beside the complete **app-files** folder. Do not run the launcher from inside the ZIP.
- Open **Digital Marathon.app** inside the shared folder, beside the Windows .bat. No separate Mac download is needed.

Folder layout

```
digital-marathon/  
|-- Digital Marathon.app  
|-- Start Digital Marathon - Windows.bat  
|-- Start Screen Recorder - Linux.sh  
|-- REPAIR_MAC_PERMISSIONS.command  
|-- README.md  
|-- QUICK_START.txt  
|-- CHANGELOG.md  
`-- app-files/
```

Supporting files

app-files includes the Windows runtime, application JAR, source, native components, resources, guides, scripts and license notices. Runtime license texts are included with each runtime.

Updating without interrupting your session

Download, verify and extract into a new folder while the app continues. When ready, quit it and open the new launcher. Restarting activates the new version; numerical history stays outside the launch folder.

Full View

The Classic Mac dashboard keeps every existing control.

Metric	Color and meaning
Mouse distance	Blue: accumulated on-screen cursor travel in the selected distance unit.
Key presses	Green: total physical presses; no typed text or individual key identities are stored.
Mouse clicks	Amber: the total number of mouse-button presses.
Active time	Violet: elapsed collection time while tracking runs.

Controls and actions

The top area keeps the Digital Marathon icon, monitoring status, capture-status shield, transparency bar, appearance control, Mini View and Help & About. The labeled **My Digital Marathon Certificate** button opens the selected-range report.

Range, distance unit, **Display PPI**, **Permissions** and custom date/time fields remain available. Activity trend and Interval breakdown preserve both the visual summary and original numerical totals.

Action	What it does
Pause / Resume Tracking	Pause or resume collection. The button stays neutral; its text and icon show the tracking state.
Reset Session	Zero the current live session without deleting saved history.
Export CSV	Save the selected time range for a spreadsheet or analysis.
Clear History	Permanently delete saved history after a confirmation. This cannot be undone.

Time is context

Active collection time does not measure attention, task completion or productivity. Mouse travel, keys and clicks are activity context, not a work-quality score.

Mini View, appearance & hints

Keep the familiar Mini View body; enjoy the refreshed top toolbar.

The body stays familiar

- Mouse and Clicks share the soft-blue card, with their existing blue and amber headings.
- Keys keeps its soft-green card and green heading.
- The bottom strip keeps the selected range, divider and green **Active** timer with hours, minutes and seconds.
- The range and numerical totals stay in sync with Full View.

Only the top toolbar changes

The toolbar keeps the capture shield, transparency bar, appearance, Always on Top pin and Full View control. The pin highlights when enabled. Update attention uses a compact notice and Full View badge, preserving its dimensions and controls. Reviewing restores Full View before showing one shared nonmodal notes/progress panel. **Back to Mini** closes it first, then restores the previous position, transparency, pin setting and session. Repeated actions do not create duplicate panels/downloads. No update dialog opens over Mini View.

Continuous 0-75% transparency

Both views use a **rounded tab handle** with a slightly deeper soft tint for clearer visibility in both themes, without a halo. Bar, tab and control geometry stays the same. Drag the tab or click the bar for **0%** to **75%** transparency. Zero is opaque; 75% is most transparent. Smooth dragging changes the value without moving the window; keyboard arrow-key adjustment remains available. Move the window from clear header space or Mini View's range strip. Unsupported desktops return to an opaque window.

Short tooltips that do not cover counters

Control hints use short wording on an opaque light or dark surface. They appear away from window content and dismiss when the pointer leaves the control. Mini View mouse, click and key values intentionally have no tooltips.

Remembered view

The app reopens in the view last used. Mini View remembers its position; Full View remembers its position and size. Theme, transparency, distance unit and Display PPI are saved preferences.

Your data remains local

Window appearance and position do not change what is counted or where numerical history is stored.

Ranges, units & activity trend

Choose a period, then read both direction and detail.

Range	Useful for
Current session	Live collection since the latest session reset or local midnight rollover.
Last 1 / 2 / 6 / 12 hours	Short-term review.
Today / Yesterday / This week	Calendar-based review.
Last 7 / 30 days	Recent patterns and comparison.
Last 6 months	Longer trends, aggregated roughly weekly.
Last 1 / 2 / 5 years	Monthly or quarterly long-term trends.
Custom range	Exact From and To date/time fields.

Distance units and Display PPI

All nine units remain available: Pixels, Millimetres, Centimetres, Metres, Kilometres, Inches, Feet, Yards and Miles. Pixels represent exact screen coordinates. Metric and imperial values use **Display PPI** and estimate on-screen cursor travel, not exact physical desk movement. Pointer acceleration, display scaling and multiple displays can affect that estimate.

Bars = activity | Line = trend

Soft blue bars show each interval's relative activity level. A thin coral line connects the bar tops to make rises and falls easy to follow. The Y axis runs from 0% to 100% relative activity. Different input totals use different units, so this relative scale does not claim they share one physical measure.

Hover or click anywhere along the trend line to see the closest recorded interval's date/time, mouse distance, keys, clicks, active time and relative activity. Values are real interval totals, never invented intermediate values. Only the line point highlights; bars stay unchanged with no shaded interval band. The opaque detail stays visible during live updates. **Interval breakdown** keeps the original totals in a table.

Your Digital Marathon Certificate

The selected Classic Award design, with the original gold award badge.

- Choose a range in Full View and click **My Digital Marathon Certificate**.
- Review Mouse distance, Key presses, Mouse clicks and Active time.
- The report keeps the marathon comparison, activity meter, achievements and finish-line verdict.
- Enter **Name on Certificate** and choose **Download Certificate**.
- The JPEG saves in **Downloads** automatically, with a timestamped filename.

Classic Award design

The report uses a flat blue download button, colored totals, a slim meter and achievement tiles. The JPEG keeps warm paper, a fine gold double border, centered name and the original gold laptop badge at top right. Higher-quality export uses **97% JPEG quality** and **full-color 4:4:4 sampling** for finer detail and colored edges.

Element	Purpose
Recipient name	The name you enter, printed prominently on the certificate.
Selected range	The same time period chosen in Full View.
Colored activity totals	Mouse distance, key presses, clicks and active time.
Original gold laptop badge	The familiar award seal stays at the top right.
Award attribution	Awarded by Digital Marathon; Girish Gupta; girish.gupta@gmail.com.
Timestamped filename	Repeat downloads do not overwrite earlier certificates.

For fun, with privacy

The activity meter is not a productivity score. Mouse travel is compared with a 42.195 km marathon for context. The report and certificate contain aggregate numerical totals and no typed content.

After download

Certificate saved shows the filename and folder. Use **Open Certificate**, **Show in Folder** or **Copy file location**; **Done** closes the notice. Opening files requires desktop support. Check Downloads if needed. Totals reflect the range, unit and PPI when the report opened.

Launch on macOS

A self-contained Apple Silicon app with its Java runtime included.

Step	What to do
1	Extract the complete combined ZIP. Open Digital Marathon.app inside the shared digital-marathon folder.
2	If macOS blocks the app, try right-click > Open . After a blocked attempt, use System Settings > Privacy & Security > Open Anyway .
3	Enable Digital Marathon in Privacy & Security > Input Monitoring . Enable Accessibility as well if requested.
4	The app retries after permission is enabled. Quit and reopen if macOS asks.
5	Test in Notes or TextEdit: type letters, numbers and Space, then click in another app. Keys and clicks should rise while the tracker is not selected.

Requirements and signature

Apple Silicon, macOS 11+, with Java included. Local development needs no Apple Developer account or notarization; the app uses an ad-hoc signature. Browser-downloaded unnotarized copies can still be blocked. Local checks do not guarantee prompt-free launch for every Mac or download. Consider notarization later for public distribution.

If counts stay at zero

Check Input Monitoring and Accessibility for the app at its current location. If enabled but counting still fails, run **REPAIR_MAC_PERMISSIONS.command**, re-enable Digital Marathon and reopen it from that location. The helper resets permission records, not activity history.

Permissions help opens a compact themed window with short setup steps. Use **Open Input Monitoring** or **Open Accessibility** for the matching System Settings pane. Detailed recovery steps remain in Help > Troubleshooting.

Protected input contexts

Terminal Secure Keyboard Entry intentionally prevents global keyboard observation. Some other protected contexts can also restrict counting. Digital Marathon does not bypass these security boundaries. Test in a normal text editor when diagnosing input access.

The direct Mac app launcher does not create a separate startup log. Check any app error message and the monitoring status in Full View.

Launch on Windows & Linux

Windows launches directly; Linux keeps the original first-launch build path.

Windows 10/11 x64

- Extract the complete **digital-marathon** folder.
- Double-click **Start Digital Marathon - Windows.bat**. Keep it beside **app-files** for future launches.
- If SmartScreen appears for a package you trust, use **More info > Run anyway** when available.
- Java is bundled. The launcher does not build the app or download tools.
- If files are missing, extract the entire ZIP again. Launch and application logs are in **%LOCALAPPDATA%\DigitalMarathon\logs**.
- If global counts stay zero, check endpoint-security or application-control software for a blocked input hook, then restart after allowing it.

Linux

Use **Start Screen Recorder - Linux.sh**. Linux retains the original first-launch build, which can take a few minutes and may need internet access. Later launches reuse the built app. The startup/build log is **app-files/digital-marathon-startup.log**.

```
chmod +x "Start Screen Recorder - Linux.sh"  
./"Start Screen Recorder - Linux.sh"
```

On X11, the app uses its global input hook. Wayland blocks ordinary global observation, so Digital Marathon uses passive evdev input readers when the user can read **/dev/input/event***. Follow **app-files/docs/LINUX-WAYLAND.md** for the included active-user udev rule or the distribution's input-group method.

Linux input access

Read access to input event devices is a broad operating-system permission. Grant it only to trusted software and users. The app stores totals only, but the permission itself can expose raw input events. These interface changes do not grant that permission automatically.

Capture privacy, sleep & local data

Use the status indicators to understand the current protection and monitor state.

Hide from screenshots & sharing

The Full View toggle is off by default. Its outer surface and border stay neutral; only the switch track and knob change. When on, the app requests supported capture exclusion. An accented shield in both top toolbars means protection is applied; a neutral shield means it is off or unavailable.

Platform	Capture behavior
macOS	AppKit window-sharing protection.
Windows	WDA_EXCLUDEFROMCAPTURE. Intended exclusion is available on Windows 10 version 2004 and later.
KDE Plasma 6.7+	A dedicated KWin per-window capture-exclusion rule.
Other Linux desktops	No equivalent portable app-controlled exclusion is available; the app reports the limitation.

Capture exclusion depends on the operating system, compositor and capture application. It cannot block an external camera, and privileged or nonstandard capture methods may bypass normal exclusion. Transparency is a separate appearance setting.

Sleep and lid-close resume

The monitor automatically recovers after sleep and clears stale held-key and pointer state. Windows and X11 re-register hooks when needed. Linux Wayland reopens passive evdev readers if device nodes change. Linux input devices are not grabbed.

Local saved history

macOS/Linux: ~/.digital_marathon/activity-buckets.dat
Windows: %APPDATA%\DigitalMarathon\activity-buckets.dat

The app stores numerical totals and time-bucketed history plus preferences. It does not store typed text, individual key identities, clipboard contents, screenshots, application names or window titles. Certificate JPEGs remain local files in Downloads. There is no cloud account or remote activity database.

At local midnight, the live day starts at zero and the completed day remains in history. Reset Session preserves history; Clear History permanently deletes saved activity history after confirmation.

Updates & basic usage

Download while you work; save and close when ready to run the new version.

One shared update panel

Checks start after about **2.5 seconds**, then every **15 minutes** while open; manual checks are in **Help > About**. GitHub API failure/limits use same-repository public metadata with verification. Matching versions are up to date. Mini review restores Full View for one nonmodal panel. Notes scroll with keyboard support. No closed-app notices.

Action	What happens
Update Now	Downloads and verifies source, product/version, safe paths, archive CRC and SHA-256 while tracking continues.
Remind / Skip	Remind Me Later waits 24 hours. Skip This Version hides automatic prompts; manual checks still work.
Back to Mini / Close Review	Closes the panel; downloads continue. Mini restores position, transparency, pin and session.
Retry	Retries after an update error; duplicate actions are guarded.

Verified download: save, close and launch

Show Downloaded Update opens the folder. Extract into a new folder while working. **Save & Close for Update** saves settings, history and a one-use session record, waiting for active exports, saves and dialogs. A saving failure keeps the app open/running. Then open the new **.app** or **.bat** yourself. Same-day launch resumes totals, start time and running/paused state; across midnight normal rollover applies. History stays local. No automatic install/reopen or replacement while running.

Basic usage analytics

Reporting is automatic, including older opt-outs, with no toggle. The shared PulseStudio PostHog project receives **digital_marathon_** events with **app_id = digital-marathon** filters; its dashboard stays unchanged. Events use basic runtime/session/feature categories and random IDs. Input totals, text, names, paths and history stay local. IP exists in transit; no GeoIP, person profiles, recording or autocapture. See **ANALYTICS.md**.

Owner publishing

Mac: **Publish Digital Marathon.command**; Windows: **Publish Digital Marathon - Windows.bat**. Both use one ZIP, verifying it, checksum and generated metadata. Mac publishing needs Python 3; app launch does not. See **PUBLISHING.md**.

Help & troubleshooting

Use the in-app guidance, then include the precise status when reporting a problem.

What you notice	What to check
GitHub limit during update check	2.1.31 uses public metadata fallback. Older 2.1.29/30: wait for the shared API quota to reset, then check in About; install 2.1.31 manually if it recurs.
Counters do not change	Confirm tracking is running; read its status. Test in a text editor and check input permissions.
Mouse distance seems wrong	Verify Display PPI and selected unit. Converted distance is on-screen travel, not exact desk movement.
Certificate totals surprise you	Confirm the selected range, unit and Display PPI. The report mirrors those settings.
Certificate not found	Use Show in Folder or Copy file location. Files save to Downloads.
History seems different	Check the range. Reset Session affects live totals; Clear History requires confirmation.
Window appearance differs	Check appearance, transparency and OS display scaling. Full View and the report are resizable.
Windows launch problem	Keep the entire folder together and review %LOCALAPPDATA%\DigitalMarathon\logs.
Linux launch problem	Review app-files/digital-marathon-startup.log and the Wayland guide where applicable.

Help & About

Help includes Overview, Help, Troubleshooting, About and Contact Us. **About** has **Check for updates**. This version 2.1.31 guide opens in the app. README, QUICK_START and platform guides cover current launchers and controls.

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Include OS, app version, tracking/monitoring status and a text-editor test. For certificates, include range, unit and PPI; for launch failures, the log message.